

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 4

♥ Q 8 2

♦ Q 10

♣ K J 9 7

♠ J 5

♥ A K 7 4 3

♦ 8 4 3

♣ 6 3 2



♠ Q 7 6 2

♥ J 9 5

♦ K J 9 7

♣ Q 10

♠ A K 3

♥ 10 6

♦ A 6 5 2

♣ A 8 5 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

2NT

All Pass

2NT by South

little to work with. In fact, the only real chance you have is to establish dummy's ♥ suit.

You must find the ♥s split 3-3. Even then, with no entries in dummy outside the ♥ suit you cannot afford to play ♥ A K followed by a third one. True, the suit would be established, but you could never get to it.

So you win the first trick with your ♠K, then play a ♥, ducking in dummy.

An opponent will win the ♥, but whatever they return you win one of your Aces. Then play your last ♥ to dummy. If the suit splits you will make 4 ♥ tricks to go with your 4 other top honors.

You were very lucky to find a 3-3 ♥ split. This happens only about 40% of the time.

But if you had not made the correct plan your good fortune would have been wasted.

Partner's 2♦ bid is a transfer so you bid 2♥. Partner now bids 2NT.

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Partner is describing an invitational hand (9-10 points) with a 5-card ♥ suit. With a bare 15 points and doubleton ♥ you just pass.

West leads the ♠10 against your 2NT.

You try dummy's ♠J hopefully, but East puts on the ♠Q.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 6

You must find two more winners. And you have very

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10 8 6 4

♥ 8 3

♦ 7 2

♣ K 10 6 5

♠ 7 5 2

♥ A Q 6

♦ A Q 6 5 3

♣ 7 3

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W		E
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♠ J 3

♥ J 10 9 2

♦ J 9 8 4

♣ Q J 9

♠ K Q 9

♥ K 7 5 4

♦ K 10

♣ A 8 4 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

♠s. On the other hand, East might well switch to ♣s, and that would certainly be unwelcome. Finally, if you do win the first ♠ you have another stopper if you can prevent East from getting the lead. So win the first trick with the ♠K. Notice that by winning with the ♠K you keep West in the dark as to whether you or East has the ♠Q.

You need just one more trick, and either red suit might split 3-3. So is that your plan? Lead out red winners and hope?

Truthfully, that wouldn't be a terrible plan. The chance of a 3-3 split in a suit is about 36%. But since you need either of two 36% chances that comes to almost 60% (if you aren't Math oriented don't worry about it, you can trust me).

There's a safer approach though; remember you only need 4 ♦ tricks, not 5.

There is a wonderful "safety play" that will practically guarantee your contract. Enter dummy with a ♥, then play a small ♦ toward your hand and finesse with your ♦10! West may win with the ♦J, but even if he does he is the Safe Hand and cannot play a ♠ without giving you a trick. And whatever else he could play you would win and make 4 ♦ tricks. In the actual Deal the ♦ finesse actually works and you make all 5 tricks in the suit.

The only way this plan could go wrong is if West held the singleton ♦J. And if that were the case you wouldn't make the contract anyway (unless ♥s were 3-3).

You don't have enough points to be thinking about slam and you don't particularly want to play 5 ♦. So you bid 3NT and everybody passes.

The contract would be 3NT played by North.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠6; East plays the ♠J.

Your immediate problem is whether or not to hold up. ???

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 8

There is some merit in a holdup. East is likely to have just 2 ♠s, so a holdup would exhaust his cards in the suit. If he later got the lead he would have no